



Tier Structure — Discussion Document

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Purpose of This Document

This document is a working discussion on the subscription tier structure for YT Transcriber. It is not a final specification — pricing is intentionally excluded at this stage. The goal is to agree on **tier names** and **which features sit at each level**, with a focus on making the progression between tiers feel natural and earned rather than artificially gated.

Three tiers are proposed: **Free**, **Pro**, and **Enterprise**. Each should feel like a complete, coherent product — not a stripped-down version of the one above it. The principle: *Free gives real value. Pro unlocks serious use. Enterprise enables teams.*

Tier Overview

FREE	PRO	ENTERPRISE
Try it out	Serious use	Team & power
No card required. Limited videos. Core features only.	Unlimited videos. All core + advanced features. Monthly subscription.	Everything in Pro. Team workspaces, API access, scheduled automation.
Target: curious users, students, light use	Target: content creators, researchers, professionals	Target: agencies, teams, power users, B2B

Feature Matrix

The table below shows the proposed feature allocation across all three tiers. Features marked with a note are discussed in detail in the following section.

Feature	Free	Pro	Enterprise
Transcription			
YouTube URL submission	✓	✓	✓
Transcript viewer	✓	✓	✓
Timestamped sentences	✓	✓	✓
Clickable timestamps → video player	✓	✓	✓
Real-time transcript search	✓	✓	✓
Duplicate detection	✓	✓	✓
Monthly video limit	3 videos	Unlimited	Unlimited
Export			
Plain text (.txt) export	✓	✓	✓
PDF transcript export	✗	✓	✓
Word document (.docx) export	✗	✓	✓
ZIP archive (transcript + assets)	✗	✓	✓
SRT subtitle file export	✗	✓	✓

Notes & Organisation			
Per-video notes panel	✓	✓	✓
Video renaming (custom title)	✓	✓	✓
Video deletion	✓	✓	✓
Collections / folders	✗	✓	✓
Video tagging	✗	✓	✓
Library search (across all videos)	✗	✓	✓
Sharing			
Shareable read-only transcript link	✗	✓	✓
Share link expiry (24h / 7d / 30d)	✗	✓	✓
Download permission on share link	✗	✓	✓
Link & URL Features			
URL detection in transcript	✓	✓	✓
URL screenshots (via screenshot API)	✗	✓	✓
Links panel with timestamps	✓	✓	✓
AI Features			
AI chapter markers	✗	✓	✓
AI summary (one paragraph)	✗	✓	✓
Key quotes extraction	✗	✓	✓
Action items extraction	✗	✓	✓
Transcript correction (inline edit)	✗	✓	✓
Auto-translation	✗	✓	✓
Automation & API			
Scheduled channel transcription	✗	✗	✓
Scheduled playlist transcription	✗	✗	✓
Email digest (weekly summary)	✗	✓	✓
Webhook notifications	✗	✗	✓
REST API access	✗	✗	✓
Team & Workspace			
Team workspace (shared library)	✗	✗	✓
Team roles (Owner / Editor / Viewer)	✗	✗	✓
Workspace activity feed	✗	✗	✓
Custom branding on exports	✗	✗	✓
Platform			
Themes (5 colour options)	✓	✓	✓

Priority processing	✗	✗	✓
Billing portal (self-service)	✗	✓	✓
Account settings page	✓	✓	✓



Included



Not included

Discussion Notes

The following notes explain the reasoning behind key placement decisions and flag items that may benefit from further discussion before the tier structure is finalised.

Transcript search on Free

Search is kept on Free because it is a core part of reading a transcript — hiding it would make the free experience feel broken rather than limited. Users who find value in search on Free are more likely to upgrade for volume and export, not because search was taken away.

■ **KEEP on Free — this is a usability feature, not a power feature.**

URL detection on Free vs URL screenshots on Pro

Detecting links in the transcript (showing them in the links panel) is a core transcript feature and should be free. Taking screenshots of those URLs is computationally expensive — it calls an external screenshot API per URL. Keeping it on Pro is justified by the real cost and the 'wow factor' it creates as an upgrade hook.

■ **SPLIT: detection = Free, screenshots = Pro. This feels natural, not gated.**

AI features on Pro (not Enterprise)

AI chapters, summaries, and quotes are placed on Pro rather than Enterprise because they are the primary upgrade hook for individual users. Reserving them for Enterprise would undermine the value of Pro and push the perceived price of AI too high. Enterprise's differentiation comes from team features and automation, not AI.

■ **AI on Pro — key upgrade driver for individuals.**

Transcript correction on Pro

Inline transcript editing is a lightweight feature technically, but it implies a level of investment in the content — the user is treating the transcript as a working document. This fits the Pro persona (content creators, researchers) well.

■ **KEEP on Pro — low build cost, good persona fit.**

Email digest on Pro (not Enterprise only)

A weekly summary email of new transcripts is low-cost to send and increases weekly active use. Putting it on Pro gives active solo users a reason to stay engaged. Enterprise gets the more powerful version: webhook notifications and scheduled automation.

■ **Email digest = Pro. Webhooks + automation = Enterprise.**

Collections / folders on Pro

Organisation features make sense only once a user has enough videos to need them. Free users are limited to 3 videos total, so folders on Free would be wasted. Pro unlocks unlimited videos, at which point folders become genuinely useful.

■ **KEEP on Pro — no use case on Free at 3-video limit.**

Tier name alternatives worth considering

Current working names: Free / Pro / Enterprise. Alternatives that could be considered: **Free / Creator / Studio** (from Model C in the Clerk Proposal) — these are more identity-led and aspirational. 'Pro' is clear but generic. 'Creator' and 'Studio' signal who the product is for. Enterprise is strong and widely understood for the top tier.

■ **DISCUSS: Free / Pro / Enterprise vs Free / Creator / Studio. Both work — one is clearer, one is more branded.**

Features intentionally not listed

The following are on the longer-term roadmap and are not allocated to a tier yet: podcast/audio file support, browser extension, mobile app, Notion/Google Docs integrations, semantic search, speaker diarisation, Zapier/Make webhooks. These will be added to this document once development timelines are clearer.

■ Backlog items — tier placement TBD.

Next Steps

- **Agree tier names** — confirm Free / Pro / Enterprise or choose identity-led alternatives (e.g. Free / Creator / Studio).
- **Review feature placement** — use the discussion notes above to confirm or adjust which features sit at each tier.
- **Agree video limits on Free** — current proposal is 3 videos total (lifetime, not monthly). A permanent monthly free tier (3/mo) is an alternative that drives ongoing engagement.
- **Define Pro volume** — Pro is currently unlimited. An alternative is a generous monthly cap (e.g. 60 videos/mo) to create a natural Enterprise upsell for heavy users.
- **Pricing discussion (separate session)** — once features are confirmed, pricing can be set based on competitive research and ARPU targets from the revenue models in the Clerk Proposal.
- **Update the build plan** — once tiers are confirmed, the feature flag table in the database schema and the Next.js build plan can be finalised.